01 / EXAMPLE FRAMEWORK

ASSESSMENT OF ENVIRONMENTAL EFFECTS

An educational structure for thinking through a resource consent AEE. This is not a completed AEE and should not be lodged as supplied.

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01 / FRAME THE QUESTION

Purpose and scope

Start with the activity requiring resource consent, applicable assessment requirements, the site, and the information available. An AEE should be proportionate to the scale and significance of effects.

Section	What an AEE should explain
Site and receiving environment	Location, legal description, existing uses, surrounding environment and relevant site characteristics.
The activity	What is proposed, how it will operate, related works and other consent requirements.
Statutory framework	Applicable zone, overlays, provisions, national direction and relevant assessment matters.
Environmental effects	Actual and potential effects, with evidence proportionate to the proposed activity.
Mitigation and alternatives	Avoidance, remedy, mitigation, design responses and alternatives where legally relevant.
Consultation and affected persons	Record who was consulted, what was raised and how it was addressed where appropriate.
Conclusion and appendices	Summary of effects and supporting drawings, reports and references.

02 / ASSESSMENT METHOD

Connect an effect to its evidence

- Define the change produced by the activity and the existing environment.
- Identify the receptor or environment potentially affected.
- Describe the nature, scale, duration and significance of relevant effects.
- Reference appropriately qualified specialist reports where needed.
- Explain proposed mitigation and the residual effects after mitigation.

03 / PREPARATION CHECK

Before describing an effect, verify

- Are plans, site facts and the activity description consistent?
- Are the relevant current provisions and assessment matters identified?
- Have matters excluded by statutory changes been excluded appropriately?
- Are data sources, assumptions and limitations recorded?
- Does a specialist need to assess flooding, access, traffic, ecology or land stability?

04 / NEXT ACTION

Use this as a checklist, not a substitute

Use the current council guidance and Schedule 4 requirements relevant to the application. Seek a site-specific review before lodging a resource consent application.

IMPORTANT / Official reference: Auckland Council AEE guide — https://www.aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/building-and-consents/resource-consents/prepare-resource-consent-application/Documents/assessment-environmental-effects-template.pdf

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GENERAL INFORMATION ONLY / This example is not a prepared consent application, certified report, advice on a specific site, or evidence of completed client work. Confirm applicable legislative requirements, current council forms and specialist input before use.